

Word family: ****tire / tires / tired / tiring / tiredness / tireless / tirelessly****

****Base word:**** tire

****Past tense:**** tired

****Past participle:**** tired

****Related forms:**** tired, tiring, tiredness, tireless, tirelessly

****Important spelling note:**** ****tire**** also means the rubber covering around a wheel in American English; British English usually spells that noun ****tyre****

****Useful expressions / extensions:**** tire easily, tire of something, grow tired of, tired of, tired from, tired after, tire someone out

****Part of speech:**** verb (動詞) / adjective family (相關形容詞) / separate noun homograph (另有同形名詞)

Your sentence:

> “I thought it might be ****tiring**** at first, because young children can be noisy and unpredictable.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, ****tiring**** means:

> ****causing someone to become physically or mentally tired because something requires a lot of energy, attention, or effort****

Looking after a young child may require constant attention and energy, so the speaker originally expected it to be exhausting.

****繁體中文：** ****令人疲倦的；因需要持續付出體力、精神或注意力而使人累的****

****中文翻譯：** ******

> “I thought it might be tiring at first...”

「一開始我以為這可能會很****累人 / 令人疲倦****.....」

Here:

****tiring = 會令人感到疲累、消耗體力或精神的****

1. ****tire = become tired (變累) — 疲倦；感到累****

This is the basic verb underlying ****tiring****.

Practice 1

> “Young children often ****tire**** quickly after a busy day.”

「小朋友忙了一整天後通常很快就會****累****。」

Practice 2

> “I ****tire**** more easily than I used to.”

「我現在比以前更容易****疲倦****。」

****tire** = 身體或精神逐漸失去精力，開始感到疲倦******

2. ****tire someone** = make someone tired (使疲倦) — 使.....累；令人疲倦******

A transitive use.

Practice 3

> “Long journeys ****tire**** me.”

「長途旅程會令我****很累****。」

Practice 4

> “The constant noise ****tired**** everyone.”

「持續的噪音令大家都****很疲倦****。」

****tire someone** = 使某人的體力或精神逐漸消耗，令其感到疲倦******

3. ****tiring** = causing tiredness (令人疲倦的) — 累人的；令人疲累的******

This is the exact form and sense in your passage.

Practice 5 — Original

> “I thought it might be ****tiring**** at first.”

「一開始我以為這可能會很****累人****。」

Practice 6

> “Looking after three young children can be **tiring**.”

「照顧三個年幼的小朋友可能很**累人**。」

Practice 7

> “It was a long and **tiring** day.”

「那是漫長而**令人疲倦**的一天。」

tiring = 因需要較多體力、精神或注意力而令人感到疲倦的

4. **tired** = feeling physically or mentally exhausted (感到疲倦的) — 累的 ; 疲倦的

A crucial contrast with **tiring**.

Practice 8

> “I’m really **tired** after work.”

「我下班後真的很**累**。」

Practice 9

> “She looked **tired** after looking after the children all day.”

「她照顧小朋友一整天後看起來很**疲倦**。」

tired = 因活動、缺乏休息或精神消耗而感到沒有精力的

5. **tired from / tired after** (因.....而累) — 因.....感到疲倦

Practice 10

> “He was **tired from** travelling.”

「他因旅行而感到**疲倦**。」

Practice 11

> “I was **tired after** the long walk.”

「走了很久之後，我感到很**累**。」

****tired from/after = 因某活動或經歷消耗體力 / 精神而感到疲倦****

6. ****tired of + noun/-ing (厭倦) — 厭煩；受夠了****

A major figurative extension.

Practice 12

> “I’m ****tired of**** hearing the same excuse.”

「我已經****聽厭了****同一個藉口。」

Practice 13

> “She became ****tired of**** the routine.”

「她逐漸對這種日常生活感到****厭倦****。」

****be tired of something = 因某事重複太多或持續太久而感到厭煩，不再想接受 / 繼續****

This is ****not physical tiredness****.

7. ****tire of + noun/-ing (逐漸厭倦) — 對.....感到厭煩****

The verb form of the same figurative branch.

Practice 14

> “He soon ****tired of**** the game.”

「他很快便對那個遊戲****感到厭倦****。」

Practice 15

> “She never ****tires of**** listening to his stories.”

「她從來不會****聽厭****他的故事。」

****tire of something = 對某事逐漸失去興趣、耐性或新鮮感****

8. **grow/get tired of (逐漸厭倦) — 開始厭煩；受夠**

Practice 16

> “People may **grow tired of** waiting.”

「人們可能會逐漸**等得不耐煩 / 厭倦等待**。」

Practice 17

> “I’m getting **tired of** this argument.”

「我開始**受夠這場爭論了**。」

grow/get tired of = 隨時間逐漸對某事感到厭煩或失去耐性

9. **tired = old / overused / no longer interesting (陳舊乏味的) — 老套的；陳腐的**

A useful figurative adjective sense.

Practice 18

> “The film relies on **tired** jokes.”

「這部電影依賴一些**老套的笑話**。」

Practice 19

> “That is a **tired** argument.”

「那是一個**陳舊、說了太多次的論點**。」

tired = 因被使用或重複太多次而失去新鮮感、顯得老套的

This is distinct from “feeling sleepy/exhausted.”

10. **tired-looking (看起來疲倦的) — 疲態的；顯得疲倦的**

Practice 20

> “He looked **tired-looking** after the trip.”

「旅程後他看起來很**疲倦**。」

Practice 21

> “The room had a slightly **tired-looking** interior.”

「那個房間的室內裝潢看起來有點**殘舊乏味**。」

tired-looking = 外表顯得疲倦、欠精神；亦可形容地方 / 物件顯得陳舊

This is a useful compound extension.

11. **tiredness** = state of being tired (疲倦) — 疲勞；疲倦感

Practice 22

> “She struggled with **tiredness** after a long day.”

「忙了一整天後，她感到很強烈的**疲倦感**。」

Practice 23

> “Lack of sleep can cause daytime **tiredness**.”

「睡眠不足可導致日間**疲倦**。」

tiredness = 身體或精神缺乏精力、感到疲累的狀態

12. **tireless** = never seeming to become tired (不知疲倦的) — 不辭勞苦的；不知疲倦的

A useful positive extension.

Practice 24

> “She is a **tireless** volunteer.”

「她是一位**不辭勞苦的義工**。」

Practice 25

> “He made **tireless** efforts to help the community.”

「他為幫助社區付出了**不懈的努力**。」

tireless = 長時間持續努力而似乎不會疲倦或放棄的

Often figurative and positive.

13. **tirelessly** = without stopping or giving up (不懈地) — 不知疲倦地；不懈地

Practice 26

> “She worked **tirelessly** for the charity.”

「她為慈善機構**不懈地工作**。」

Practice 27

> “The team worked **tirelessly** to solve the problem.”

「團隊**不辭勞苦地**努力解決問題。」

tirelessly = 長時間持續努力而不因疲累或困難而停止

14. **tire someone out** (使筋疲力盡) — 把.....累壞

A very common phrasal extension.

Practice 28

> “Looking after the children **tired me out**.”

「照顧小朋友把我**累壞了**。」

Practice 29

> “The long walk **tired everyone out**.”

「長途步行把大家都**累得筋疲力盡**。」

tire someone out = 使某人非常疲倦，消耗大量體力或精神

This is stronger than simply:

> tire someone.

15. **tire = rubber covering of a wheel (美式英語：輪胎) — 輪胎**

A completely separate noun meaning.

Practice 30

> “The car has a flat **tire**.”

「汽車有一條**輪胎漏氣 / 爆胎了**。」

Practice 31

> “We need to replace the front **tires**.”

「我們需要更換前面的**輪胎**。」

tire = 包在車輪外圍、通常由橡膠製成並接觸路面的部分

Important spelling:

* **tire** — American English

* **tyre** — British English for the wheel noun

The fatigue verb remains **tire** in both varieties.

16. **flat tire / flat tyre (爆胎 / 輪胎漏氣) — 漏氣輪胎；爆胎**

Practice 32

> “We had a **flat tire** on the way home.”

「我們回家途中遇到**爆胎 / 輪胎漏氣**。」

Practice 33

> “He stopped to change a **flat tyre**.”

「他停下來更換**漏氣的輪胎**。」

****flat tire/tyre = 因失去空氣而不能正常使用的輪胎****

17. ****spare tire / spare tyre (後備輪胎) — 後備胎****

Practice 34

> “The car has a ****spare tire**** in the trunk.”

「汽車尾箱有一條****後備輪胎****。」

Practice 35

> “They used the ****spare tyre**** after the puncture.”

「輪胎被刺穿後，他們換上了****後備胎****。」

****spare tire/tyre = 車上準備用來替換損壞輪胎的後備輪胎****

Important distinction: ****tired vs tiring****

This is the most important learner contrast.

****tired****

= describes the person who ****feels fatigue****.

> “I’m tired.”

= 我累了。

****tiring****

= describes the thing that ****causes fatigue****.

> “Looking after children is tiring.”

= 照顧小朋友很累人。

So:

> **person feels tired**

> **activity is tiring**

Your passage uses **tiring**.

Important distinction: tire vs exhaust

tire

= make someone tired / become tired.

exhaust

= make someone extremely tired, often much stronger.

> "The walk tired me."

= 步行令我累。

> "The walk exhausted me."

= 步行令我筋疲力盡。

So **exhaust** is generally stronger.

Important distinction: tired vs sleepy

tired

= lacking physical or mental energy.

sleepy

= feeling that you want to sleep.

You can be:

> tired but not sleepy

after heavy exercise.

Important distinction: **tired vs fatigued**

tired

ordinary everyday English.

fatigued

more formal/technical, especially in medical, occupational, or scientific contexts.

> “I’m tired.”

is much more natural in daily conversation.

Important distinction: **tired of vs tired from**

This is crucial.

tired from

= physically/mentally fatigued because of something.

> “I’m tired from work.”

= 工作令我累。

tired of

= bored/annoyed because something has continued or repeated too much.

> “I’m tired of this work.”

= 我厭倦了這份工作。

Very different meanings.

Important distinction: **tire of vs get tired**

tire of something

= become bored with it.

> “She tired of the routine.”

get tired

= become physically/mentally fatigued.

> “She got tired after walking.”

The presence of **of** changes the meaning dramatically.

Important distinction: **tired = exhausted vs tired = stale/overused**

Physical:

> “I feel tired.”

= 我很累。

Figurative:

> “a tired joke”

= 老套、講過太多次的笑話。

The second means:

> no longer fresh or interesting.

Important distinction: **tireless vs not tired**

not tired

simply means:

> currently not feeling fatigue.

tireless

usually praises persistent effort:

> energetic and unwilling to stop despite prolonged work.

> “a tireless campaigner”

= 一位不懈努力的人

So **tireless** is much stronger and more evaluative.

Important distinction: **tire** — fatigue vs **tire/tyre** — wheel

These are completely different lexical meanings.

Verb:

> “The work tired me.”

= 工作令我累。

Noun:

> “The tire is flat.”

= 輪胎漏氣。

And in British English:

> **tyre**

is normally used for the wheel noun, which makes the distinction visually clearer.

Family-extension note

The **tire** family is a good polysemy case because it combines:

* **tire** — become fatigued

* **tire** someone — cause fatigue

* **tired** — feeling fatigue

* **tiring** — causing fatigue

* **tired of** — bored/fed up

* **tire of** — become bored with

* **tired** — stale/overused

* **tiredness**

* **tireless**

* **tirelessly**
* **tire someone out**

and a completely separate homographic noun:

* **tire — wheel covering** in AmE
* **tyre — wheel covering** in BrE

This is exactly the sort of entry where the manual's POS, figurative-use, spelling-variant, and family sweeps are useful—but we should still avoid treating every collocation as a separate meaning.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
-----	-----
tire — become tired	身體或精神逐漸失去精力並開始感到疲倦
tire someone	消耗某人的體力 / 精神，使其感到疲倦
tiring	因需要較多體力、精神或注意力而令人感到疲倦的
tired — fatigued	因活動、缺乏休息或精神消耗而感到沒有精力的
tired from/after	因某活動 / 經歷而感到疲倦
tired of	因某事持續或重複太久而感到厭煩、受夠
tire of	對某事逐漸失去興趣、耐性或新鮮感
grow/get tired of	隨時間開始對某事感到厭倦
tired — stale/overused	因被使用或重複太多次而顯得老套、乏味的
tiredness	身體或精神缺乏精力、感到疲累的狀態
tireless	長時間持續努力而似乎不會疲倦或放棄的
tirelessly	不因疲累或困難而停止地持續努力
tire someone out	使某人非常疲倦；把某人累壞
tire — AmE wheel noun	包在車輪外圍、通常由橡膠製成的輪胎
tyre — BrE wheel noun	英式英語中表示輪胎的拼法
flat tire/tyre	因失去空氣而不能正常使用的輪胎
spare tire/tyre	用來替換損壞輪胎的後備輪胎

For your original sentence

> “I thought it might be **tiring** at first, because young children can be noisy and unpredictable.”

The exact meaning is:

tiring = 需要持續付出體力、精神或注意力，因此會令人感到疲倦的

Therefore:

> **looking after him might be tiring**

= **「照顧他可能會很累人 / 很消耗精神」**

The important contrast is:

> **I might become tired.**

> = 我可能會覺得累。

versus:

> **Looking after him might be tiring.**

> = 照顧他這件事可能會很累人。

So your passage uses the **cause-of-fatigue adjective** **tiring**, not the **person-experiencing-fatigue adjective** **tired**.